IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE [TBD]

The Board of Trustees of the Jefferson Union High School District (District) proposes to adopt an education parcel tax to support various educational purposes, as outlined below. The District currently has in place a parcel tax of $58 per parcel (Measure Y) that this Measure would replace; if this Measure is approved, the District will cease to levy and collect the Measure Y parcel tax commencing with fiscal year 2027-28. This Measure, if approved by voters, would impose an annual tax of $98 per parcel for ten years, commencing with fiscal year 2027-28, and is estimated to raise approximately $3,400,000 annually. [95]

The proposed parcel tax applies to any unit of land in the District that receives a separate tax bill from San Mateo County tax collection officials. All property that would otherwise be exempt from property taxes will also be exempt from the parcel tax. Any person 65 years of age or older who owns and occupies a parcel as a principal residence may apply to the District for an exemption from the tax. Property owners who have already qualified for a senior citizen exemption under the District's current parcel tax will automatically qualify for an exemption under this Measure. [97]

The stated purposes of the proposed parcel tax are to: [10]

- Support teachers and academic programs;
- Expand and enhance career training and college preparedness classes; and
- Attract and retain qualified teachers, staff, and counselors at District schools. [26]

The Measure provides that under no circumstances shall any proceeds of the parcel tax be used for administrators' salaries, benefits, or pensions. [22]

The proceeds of the parcel tax will be placed in a special account. An annual report accounting for the amount of parcel tax funds collected and expended, and the status of any projects or programs funded by the tax, will be filed with the Board of Trustees. An independent Citizens' Oversight Committee will be appointed to review the expenditures of the parcel tax. [61]

Current law forbids any decrease in State or Federal funding to the District because of the adoption of the parcel tax. If any such funding is reduced because of the parcel tax, the amount of the tax will be reduced annually as necessary to restore that funding. [47]

A "yes" vote on this Measure would impose on property within the District an annual parcel tax of $98 for ten years, commencing with fiscal year 2027-28, for the purposes listed above. [32]

A "no" vote on this Measure would not allow the parcel tax to be levied. [15]

This Measure passes if at least two-thirds of those voting on the Measure vote "yes". [15]

---------- End of Analysis ----------

(500 word limit. 420 words)